

CLST 250: Cultural Studies Literature

Cumberland State University, Department of Cultural Studies, Fall 2026

Instructor: Professor M. Calloway Office: Humanities 318 Email: mcalloway@cumberlandstate.edu

Meetings: Tuesday and Thursday, 2:00 to 3:15 PM, Humanities 320

Course description

This course reads literature and material culture together, asking how communities tell their own stories through objects, craft, and narrative. We pair a contemporary novel with primary craft sources and write toward an original research paper.

Required text

Clara Whitfield, *The Glass Forest* (2022). Additional readings posted to Google Classroom.

Grading

Component	Weight
Participation and discussion	15 percent
Reading responses	20 percent
Research paper draft	15 percent
Final research paper	30 percent
Final exam	20 percent

Key dates

Date	Item
October 19	Reading response 3 due
November 13	Research paper draft due, 5 pages, by 11:59 PM
December 7	Final research paper due, 8 to 10 pages
December 9	Final exam, in class

Research paper

Choose a craft or material tradition tied to an American community and argue how it carries cultural meaning. Use at least eight sources. Drafts are exchanged for peer review through the course Typeform before the draft deadline.

Academic integrity

All written work must be your own. Cite every source. Submitting work you did not write, or having someone else write it, is a violation of university policy.